

Writing Group Critique Policy

Purpose

The purpose of this group is to provide constructive, respectful, and encouraging feedback that helps writers improve their craft in a supportive environment. We welcome multiple genres and writing styles and recognize that every manuscript is a work in progress.

Guidelines for Writers Submitting Pages

Submission Length

- Maximum submission length: 1.5 spaced pages, no more than 2000 words
- Standard manuscript formatting preferred:
 - 12-point Times New Roman or Bookman Old Style
 - 1.5 spaced
 - Microsoft Word format (.doc or .docx) if sent electronically

Before Submitting

Writers should:

- Submit polished work whenever possible
- Be open to honest feedback
- Understand critiques are opinions, not commands
- Let the group know if specific feedback is desired
 - Example:
 - pacing
 - dialogue
 - romance chemistry
 - worldbuilding
 - clarity
- **This is not meant to be a grammar check**

During Critique

Writers agree to:

- Listen without interrupting
- Avoid defending or explaining the manuscript during critique
- Take notes if desired
- Ask clarifying questions after feedback is complete

Respect for the Group

- Arrive prepared and on time
 - Respect time limits
 - Critique others if submitting work yourself
 - Keep shared manuscripts confidential
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Guidelines for Members Giving Critiques

Be Constructive

The goal is to help the writer strengthen the manuscript, not discourage them.

Helpful feedback:

- identifies confusion
- points out strengths
- explains reactions clearly
- offers suggestions when appropriate

Avoid:

- insults
- sarcasm

- dismissive comments
- rewriting the author's voice

Critique the Writing, Not the Writer

Focus comments on the manuscript itself.

Use:

- "This scene felt rushed."
- Instead of:
- "You rushed this."

Be Specific

Specific comments are more valuable than vague reactions.

Helpful:

- "I wanted more emotional tension in this scene."

Less helpful:

- "It didn't work for me."

Balance Feedback

Members should aim to mention:

- what worked well
- memorable lines or scenes
- emotional impact
- areas needing clarification or improvement

Respect Genre Differences

This group includes multiple genres, including romance. Members should critique based on:

- clarity
- execution
- pacing
- character consistency
- not personal genre preference.

A member may not personally read a genre but can still offer valuable feedback as a reader.

Group Standards

Confidentiality

All shared work remains private within the group.

Respectful Environment

Disagreements are acceptable. Personal attacks are not.

Time Awareness

To ensure fairness for all members:

- critiques should remain concise and focused
- meeting moderators may redirect discussions if needed

Final Note

Every critique is one reader's perspective. Writers are encouraged to consider feedback thoughtfully while remaining true to their vision and voice.